

Q.3a (15 marks): How is the construction of power linked to the notion of conspicuous consumption and its impact...



(Don't Write anything in this A)

Q4. (a) How is the construction of power linked to the notion of conspicuous consumption and its impact on distributive justice. (15 marks)

Power as defined by Max Weber is the ability to take independent decision even in the face of resistance.

Power when legitimised is Authority as per Robert A Dahl.

Power plays an important role in economic, political sphere as

Care

Potlatch → by Kroeber (studied by

① Yung Boas) → those who hold power conduct potlatch ceremony where they display valuable to raise status.

This is accompanied by fear which is a form of redistribution leading to distributive justice.

Things should be added on

Both given examples

in modern

② Barons of Uganda -

Chief/King who holds political power

collects taxes from individuals and

keeps a share of it for his

conspicuous/luxurious consumption

Rest is redistributed to the society

to achieve distribution justice

⇒ Conspicuous consumption actually hampers distribution justice

In above example - ~~the~~ luxurious consumption by king actually leads to unfair ~~for~~ wage of taxpayer's money and though it seems that the

remaining wealth is equally distributed
to achieve justice → true distributive
justice is not achieved here.

Thus, Power actually can lead to
decisions as per the will of power holder
and if not exercised properly can actually
hampers true justice.

Contemporary Relevance

→ Same holds true for corrupt rich leaders
of today's democratic polity

"Power corrupts" and "Absolute Power corrupts
absolutely" holds true for every society.

and can hence be dealt by actually
limiting its power by authority.

6.5